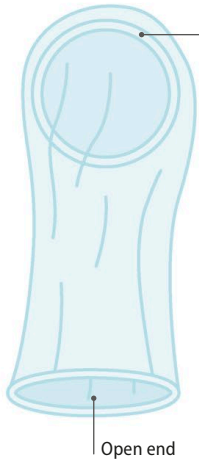


## Female barrier contraceptives

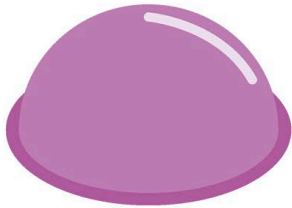
Female condoms and diaphragms are barrier contraceptives that work in a similar way to male condoms; they provide a temporary barrier between sperm and the uterus. They can be worn some time before sex and do not have to be removed immediately after sex.



A soft, flexible ring keeps the condom in place inside the vagina.

### ◀ Female condom

This is a one-size-fits-all sheath that is inserted into the vagina and held there by a soft ring. Female condoms also reduce the risk of catching an STD.



### ◀ Diaphragm

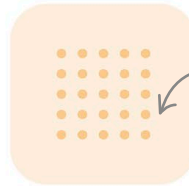
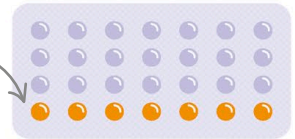
This soft silicone cap is worn inside the vagina, and covers the cervix to prevent sperm from entering the uterus. Sizes vary and should fit the wearer. Diaphragms can be washed and reused.

## Hormone-based contraceptives

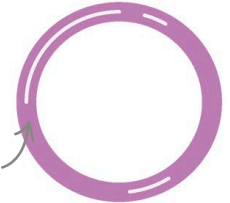
These affect a female's hormone levels in order to stop the processes that may result in pregnancy. The most common type of hormone-based contraceptive is "the pill," but there are other methods including patches, rings, implants, and injections. There are many different types available. Some stop the ovaries releasing eggs, while others prevent sperm from reaching the egg.

Hormone-based contraceptives are very effective at stopping pregnancy—as long as they are taken regularly and on time—but all are ineffective against STDs.

The pill must be taken at the same time every day.

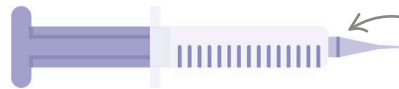


A patch should be changed each week.



A ring needs replacing every three weeks.

An implant works for three years.



An injection needs to be administered every 12 weeks.

### △ Plenty of choice

There are many different types of hormone-based contraceptives. These include pills, rings, patches, implants, and injections.

## Emergency contraceptive pill

Sometimes called the "morning-after pill," the emergency contraceptive pill is designed to be used only after unprotected sex, or when contraception doesn't work properly—if a condom splits, for example. The pill needs to be taken within 72 or 120 hours (depending on the pill type), as its effectiveness reduces over time. Most types prevent pregnancy in a variety of ways: by stopping the release of an egg, by preventing sperm from fertilizing the egg, or by stopping the fertilized egg from implanting in the uterus.

### ▷ Act fast

The morning-after pill doesn't need to be taken in the morning, but it should be taken as soon as possible following unprotected sex. It can be obtained, often for free, from a sexual health clinic or pharmacy.

